Travel Diary

Quick Guide — everything you can do in the app

Trips · Places · Notes · Offline-first

1 Create a new trip

- Bottom menu → **Trips**
- Top right → **+**
- Fill in the details:
  - **Name** of the trip (can span multiple countries, e.g. "Europe 2027")
  - **Start date** (required) · **End date** (optional)
  - **Set as active trip** — suggested automatically for every new place or note, until you activate another one

2 Add a place

A "place" can be anything: a restaurant, a bus stop, a park, a shop.

1. Tap the **+** button at the bottom — always visible, wherever you are
2. The app already suggests the active trip
3. **Country** and **City** are filled in automatically from your current GPS location — check them and edit if needed
4. Add free **tags** like `food` `park` `transport` (auto-suggested from the 3rd letter)
5. Add a first note: text, photo and/or link, all optional

> **Tip —** GPS location, country and city are all detected automatically. You don't need to do anything — just double-check them before saving, in case the GPS fix was off or you're near a border.

> **Note —** auto-filling country/city needs an internet connection at that moment. Without one, the fields just fall back to what you used last time — edit them by hand as usual.

3 Revisit a place

Going back to the same place? No need to create a new one — open the existing place and add another note.

1. Open the place (from Home, from a Trip, or by searching)
2. Tap **add note**
3. Write text, attach a photo and/or a link — each note keeps its own timestamp, building a small history of that place over time

> **Photos —** tap a photo inside a note to view it full-size, not cropped.

> **Links —** just type `www.site.com` , the app adds `https://` automatically.

4 Edit or delete

- **Place**: title, country, city, tags and GPS location can all be edited any time. Deleting a place also deletes all its notes.
- **Note**: can be edited or deleted individually, without touching the other notes on the same place.
- **Trip**: name and dates can be edited; can be deleted from the Trips list.
- **Tag**: rename or delete any tag from **Explore** → **Tags** — renaming to an existing tag's name merges the two, deleting one un-tags its places. The places and their notes are always kept.

5 Maps & pins

- Every place with GPS shows a real interactive map with a pin, right in its detail view
- Tap the expand icon on any map to view it fullscreen; tap again (or press Esc) to go back
- Editing a place: drag the pin to fine-tune its exact spot, or tap anywhere on the map to place it — typing latitude/longitude by hand still works too
- **Open in Google Maps** — link below every map, for turn-by-turn directions
- **Menu** → **Map**: shows the places closest to you right now on an actual map, with the same **1 km / 4 km / 10 km** radius buttons as Home, plus an "all" option to see every place at once
- **View on map** — button in a Trip or Country page, zooms out to show every pin from that trip or country together

> **Tip —** "download offline map" (in a Trip or Country page) pre-caches the map tiles around all your pins before you travel — do it once while on wifi, and those maps keep working with no connection afterward.

6 Tags

- **Menu** → **Explore** → **Tags**: every tag used so far, alphabetically, with a count per tag
- Tap the **pencil** icon to rename a tag, or the **trash** icon to delete it — the tagged places and their notes are left untouched either way
- Each trip also has its own **contextual tag list**: only the tags actually used in that trip

7 Search

- The Home search bar searches **live** — as you type — across both note text and tags, in your whole archive
- Results visually distinguish a **tag** match from a **text** match, and show exactly what matched — the tag name, or a short snippet of the note text
- Search also works isolated **inside a single trip** or **inside a single country**

8 Explore by country

- **Menu** → **Explore** → **Countries**: every country you've visited
- Opening a country shows every place visited there, **across all trips and all years** — great for reviewing history from home
- Toggle sorting **by date** / **by country-city** inside a trip or a country

> **New — export a country —** from `Tools → export a single country`, pick a country to download one `.json` file with every place, its tags and note text — handy to share your trip notes for a whole country in one go. Photos aren't included, to keep the file small; a note that had one is flagged as such.

9 Nearby (on Home)

Home shows the places closest to you right now, with quick radius buttons: **1 km / 4 km / 10 km**. If your phone can't detect your location, Home falls back to your most recent places.

> **Note —** browser GPS only works over a secure connection (`https://`). On an unprotected local address, location detection stays silently disabled — the rest of Home works as normal either way.

10 Sharing a place

- **"share for travel diary"**: sends the place as a file another Travel Diary user can import (`Tools → import shared entry`).
- **"share as readable file"**: sends the place as a normal page anyone can open, even without the app.

11 Backup and restore

Tools → backup & restore

- **Download backup (.zip)** — saves everything, including photos, into one file. Keep it somewhere safe (Drive, PC, email to yourself).
- **Restore from backup** — restores from a previous .zip file.

> **Careful —** restoring replaces all current data and cannot be undone.

> **Tip —** Home shows a backup reminder banner once about 10 new places pile up, or 7 days pass since your last backup — tap "backup now", or "later" to snooze it for a day.

12 Tools

Tap the **gear** icon on Home to open **Tools** — everything about your data lives here:

- Backup & restore
- Export a single country **(new)**
- Import a shared entry
- Edit / delete tags
- This quick guide

13 Installing the app

Open the site in **Chrome** (or Samsung Internet on Samsung phones) → browser menu → "Add to Home screen" / "Install app".

> **Heads up —** Firefox on Android does not install a real app — it only creates a shortcut that reopens the browser, not a standalone app.

Good to know

- The app works offline once your data and maps are loaded.
- Set a trip as "active" so new places and notes are pre-filled with it while you are travelling.
- Everything lives only on this device — use backup/export regularly if you want a copy elsewhere.